

CARROTS

Daucus carota

A garden favorite, carrots are a mainstay in the kitchen and are one of the most popular and easy vegetables to grow. They come in a variety of shapes, sizes, and colors, with maturity times that range from 50 days for small roots, to 90 days or more, depending on the variety. If carrot fly is a problem, growing the roots in raised containers may offer an effective solution.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Carrots favor open, dry sites and a light soil with a pH of 6.5–7.5. Ensure that the soil is free from stones so that roots have space to develop and do not become constricted or malformed. Dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost before planting.

Seed should be sown directly into the ground from mid-fall through to midsummer, since carrots are difficult to pot on and transplant. Sow the seeds .5–.75 in (1–2 cm) deep and space around 4 in (10 cm) apart, leaving 6 in (15 cm) between each row. By sowing successively every few weeks, it is possible to have a continuous harvest throughout the summer and fall.



Pinch out carrot leaves when thinning.

CROP CARE

Weed the area regularly by hand while the carrots are small, until their leafy canopy has grown sufficiently dense to suppress any competition. Water them during dry spells, especially if the soil starts to harden, but remember that carrots don't need as much water as some other crops; be careful not to overdo it or they will become too leafy.